



*Teaching
Genealogists AI™*
Instructor: Sylvia
Vargas

Worksheet 3 — Federal Census Multi-Year Matrix

Course: Census Records for Puerto Rican Genealogy

Module: Module 4 — U.S. Federal Census (1910–1950)

Purpose: Track one family across the 1910–1950 federal censuses to establish birth year estimates, document household changes, and log discrepancies for resolution.

Researcher Information

Field	Entry
Researcher Name	
Date of Analysis	
Family Surname(s)	
Municipality (<i>municipio</i>)	

Field	Entry
Research Question	

Source Citations by Census Year

Complete one row for each census year in which you located the family.

Census Year	Municipio / Barrio	Enumeration District	Sheet / Line	Repository / URL	Date Accessed
1910					
1920					
1930					
1940					
1950					

Multi-Year Age Matrix

Record each person's reported age in every census year where they appear. Leave the cell blank if the person is absent and note the absence in the Migration / Absence Notes column.

Person	1910 Age	1920 Age	1930 Age	1940 Age	1950 Age	Birth Year Estimate (range)	Occupation Changes	Migration / Absence Notes
--------	----------	----------	----------	----------	----------	-----------------------------	--------------------	---------------------------

Calculate each birth year estimate by subtracting the reported age from the census year. A spread of plus or minus 3 years across census years is normal; a larger spread goes in the Discrepancy Log below.

Household Stability Analysis

Summarize the household as a unit in each census year.

Year	Municipio	Barrio	Head	Spouse	Children Count	Extended Kin / Boarders	Notes
1910							
1920							

Year	Municipio	Barrio	Head	Spouse	Children Count	Extended Kin / Boarders	Notes
1930							
1940							
1950							

Discrepancy Log

Record every conflict between census years (ages, names, birthplaces, relationships). Each row should end with a concrete next action.

Year(s)	Issue	Possible Cause	Supporting Evidence	Next Action

Summary Notes

Question	Answer
Is this the same family in every census year? What confirms it?	
Who appears in one census but disappears by the next, and why might that be?	
Which birth year estimates are reliable enough to use in civil registration searches?	
What records should you search next?	